

# VAL Vendor Analysis Assistant

## Windows local deployment guide

This guide runs the current Streamlit application locally on Windows. The application authenticates with Azure using `DefaultAzureCredential`, then invokes the deployed VAL agent through the Azure AI Foundry Responses API. It requires Azure CLI sign-in or another supported Azure identity.

### 1. Prerequisites

Install:

- Python 3.11 or newer from <https://www.python.org/downloads/windows/>
- Git for Windows from <https://git-scm.com/download/win> (only if you need to clone the repository)

During Python installation, select Add Python to PATH.

### 2. Get the application

Open PowerShell and either clone the repository or change to the project folder:

```
git clone <repository-url>
cd VALAgent_Foundry
```

If the application work is on a feature branch, check out that branch before installing dependencies:

```
git checkout cursor/vendor-analysis-chat-a1f3
```

### 3. Create and activate a virtual environment

```
py -3 -m venv .venv
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
python -m pip install --upgrade pip
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

If PowerShell blocks the activation script, allow it only for the current terminal session:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

### 4. Configure Azure AI Foundry

Create a local configuration file:

```
Copy-Item .env.example .env
notepad .env
```

Replace every placeholder in `.env`:

```
AZURE_AIPROJECT_ENDPOINT=https://your-resource.services.ai.azure.com/api/projects/your-project
AZURE_AIPROJECT_API_VERSION=2025-04-01-preview
AZURE_VAL_AGENT_NAME=your-val-agent-name
AZURE_VAL_AGENT_VERSION=1
```

Use the project endpoint and deployed agent name/version from Azure AI Foundry. The API version must support agent references through the Responses API.

Keep `.env` private. It is ignored by Git and must never be committed or shared.

## 5. Authenticate with Azure CLI

Install Azure CLI if needed, then authenticate with an Azure identity that can invoke the Foundry agent:

```
az login --use-device-code
```

Complete sign-in in the displayed browser flow. The identity needs access to the target Foundry project and agent.

## 6. Run the application

With the virtual environment still active:

```
streamlit run app.py
```

Open the URL Streamlit prints, normally:

```
http://localhost:8501
```

Stop the server with `Ctrl+C`.

## 7. Verify the application

1. The sidebar should show Foundry agent configuration detected.
2. Confirm the agent information lists Foundry-managed agent.
3. Click New Conversation.
4. Send a prompt such as `Summarize the highest contract risks.`

5. Verify the assistant responds and that a follow-up question retains the prior chat context.

## Troubleshooting

| Symptom                       | Cause and resolution                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| `py` is not recognized        | Reinstall Python and select <b>**Add Python to PATH**</b> , then open a new PowerShell window.                                           |
| `streamlit` is not recognized | Activate `.env` and run `pip install -r requirements.txt` again.                                                                         |
| Configuration required        | Check all four `AZURE_AIPROJECT_*` / `AZURE_VAL_AGENT_*` values in `.env`; restart Streamlit after editing the file.                     |
| Azure authentication failed   | Run `az login --use-device-code` and use an identity that can access the Foundry project.                                                |
| Agent reference error         | Verify the agent name and version exactly match the deployed Foundry agent.                                                              |
| Network or firewall error     | Configure Foundry project networking to allow the Windows machine's network, or use the organization-approved private endpoint/VPN path. |

## Security checklist

- Store secrets only in `.env` or a managed secret store.
- Do not place credentials in `app.py`, `.env.example`, screenshots, tickets, or commits.
- Use a least-privilege Azure identity to access the Foundry project.
- Restrict Foundry project network access according to your organization's security requirements.